INDIA TODAY RPG Happiness Quest

'The pandemic has taught me to *deeply value freedom*'



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What makes me *happy*

"Since March 2020, the world has changed in many ways. The pandemic has denied us the freedom of choice and introduced stringent restrictions on work, education, travel and other social activities from time to time.... It has introduced us to a virtual world where technology is playing a large role in our day-to-day lives. We have embraced the new normal and found new ways of seeking happiness in life. The pandemic has taught me to deeply value the freedom that many of us took for granted. I have missed many family events, especially the birth of my grandnephew in the US. Today, what really makes me happy is FaceTiming with my one-year-old grandnephew on a regular basis. And while we cannot hold any physical events, at the workplace, celebrating work-related successes with my colleagues virtually gives me happiness."

Happiness Quest: *A joint enterprise of India Today and the RPG Group celebrating exemplary initiatives to spread happiness*

TIPS FOR HAPPINESS

HOW TO BRING POSITIVE VIBES TO THE OFFICE



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Having practised workspace design for 30 years and written a book on this subject, I can safely say that positivity at the workplace is extremely important for contemporary organisations and MSMEs to ensure productivity. At the end of the day, a good business is one that survives and delivers in the present VUCA (volatile, uncertain, complex and ambiguous) times. Why would people want to come back to office in a post-pandemic situation? Well, the answers can be best summarised as five fundamental truths which, if ensured, can create a positive and productive work space.

1. **An engaging space:** To make work spaces engaging, the physical environment must allow for better visual connectivity, natural light, views, greenery and good interior architecture.

2. **A great work culture:** As they say, "culture eats strategy for breakfast". It is important that there are good vibes through the organisation, with people sharing similar mindsets, ideologies, aligned aspirations and energies.

3. **An acceptance of WFA**: Investment in tools and technology that allow employees to 'work from anywhere' (WFA) is important. Today, where you are working from is not important, it is more important that the work gets done on time and is of acceptable standard.

4. **The office as a club**: With acceptance of the WFA work culture comes the need to understand that the office is now like a club that must allow for flexibility of space usage. So, make spaces multi-dimensional, versatile, optimised and home-like or 'resimercial'. Technology plays an important role here and needs to be invested in to allow for booking of seating, attendance and meeting spaces.

5. **Understanding how millennials think and what they like**: As per the 2021 Fortune Best Workplaces for Millennial survey, millennials need five things: fair pay and personal meaning; inclusive benefits; gender equality; flexibility; and inclusion in decision-making.